

Alma Lead Scheduler

Running the application locally

Prerequisites

- Python 3.12 and Node.js 20 or newer (with npm)
- Docker, to run Mailhog (a local inbox that catches outgoing email)
- A Google OAuth client ID, for attorney sign-in (see step 3)

1. Start Mailhog

Mailhog accepts email on port 1025 and shows it at `http://localhost:8025`. Nothing is delivered to real addresses.

```
docker run -d --name mailhog --platform linux/amd64 -p 1025:1025 -p 8025:8025 mailhog/mailhog
```

Later, use `docker start mailhog` and `docker stop mailhog`. To skip Mailhog, leave `SMTP_HOST` empty in the backend `.env`: emails are then only logged to the console.

2. Set up the backend

```
cd backend
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
cp .env.example .env
```

Edit backend/`.env`:

Variable	Value for local use
DATABASE_URL	sqlite:///./app.db (default)
FRONTEND_ORIGIN	http://localhost:3000
RESUME_STORAGE_DIR	./storage/resumes (default)
RESUME_MAX_BYTES	5242880 (5 MB)
GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID	your Google OAuth client ID
ATTORNEY_EMAILS	comma-separated Google accounts allowed to sign in; they also receive lead notifications
SMTP_HOST, SMTP_PORT, SMTP_STARTTLS	localhost, 1025, false for Mailhog
EMAIL_FROM	any sender address, e.g. no-reply@example.com

3. Create a Google OAuth client

- 1 In Google Cloud Console, open APIs & Services, then Credentials, and create an OAuth client ID of type **Web application**.

- 2 Add `http://localhost:3000` under **Authorized JavaScript origins**.
- 3 If the consent screen is in "Testing", add your Google account as a test user.
- 4 Use the client ID in both `GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID` (backend) and `NEXT_PUBLIC_GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID` (frontend).

4. Start the backend

From `backend/` with the `virtualenv` active:

```
uvicorn app.main:app --reload
```

The API runs at `http://localhost:8000` and its docs are at `http://localhost:8000/docs`. Tables are created automatically on startup, and `backend/app.db` is created on first run.

5. Set up and start the frontend

```
cd frontend
npm install
cp .env.example .env.local
npm run dev
```

Edit `frontend/.env.local`:

Variable	Value for local use
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_API_BASE_URL</code>	<code>http://localhost:8000/api</code>
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID</code>	the same client ID as the backend
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_RESUME_MAX_BYTES</code>	5242880 (must match the backend)

The app runs at `http://localhost:3000`.

6. Try the whole flow

- 1 Open `http://localhost:3000/apply` and submit the form with a PDF, DOC or DOCX resume.
- 2 Open `http://localhost:8025`. Two emails should be there: a confirmation to the prospect and a notification to the attorney, which links to the lead and has no attachment.
- 3 Open `http://localhost:3000/leads` and sign in with a Google account listed in `ATTORNEY_EMAILS`.
- 4 Open the lead, download the resume, and mark it as reached out. Doing it a second time is rejected.

Running the tests

```
cd backend
source .venv/bin/activate
pytest
```

Inspecting the database

The database is a plain SQLite file. Reading it while the app runs is safe:

```
sqlite3 backend/app.db "SELECT id, email, state FROM leads ORDER BY created_at DESC;"
```

Troubleshooting

- **Frontend fails at startup with "Missing required environment variable":** fill in every value in `frontend/.env.local`, then restart `npm run dev`.
- **Browser shows a CORS error:** `FRONTEND_ORIGIN` must exactly match the frontend URL, including the port. Restart `uvicorn` after changing `.env`.
- **Google sign-in is refused:** check the authorized JavaScript origin, and that your account is a test user if the consent screen is in "Testing".
- **Signed in but get "not on the attorney list":** add that exact Google email to `ATTORNEY_EMAILS` and restart the backend.
- **No emails appear in Mailhog:** confirm the container is running, `SMTP_HOST=localhost`, `SMTP_PORT=1025` and `SMTP_STARTTLS=false`, then restart the backend.
- **Errors about missing columns or tables after a model change:** there are no migrations yet. Stop the backend, delete `backend/app.db` and start it again. This erases all local leads.